Modern Savage — Pre-Launch Content Arc

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For: Calvin (Ku Creatives) — brief for Bear's Instagram content May 15 through July 1

Purpose: Six weeks of organic content on Bear's main account that builds naturally toward the Modern Savage launch without looking like a product campaign. The Liver King lesson: the moment people smell a build-up, they discount everything. This arc works in reverse — each post stands alone, and the launch is the payoff they didn't see coming.

The Principle

Bear does not telegraph launches. He shares his life.

The pre-launch arc is NOT:

- "Teaser 1 of 6 — something exciting is coming"
- Product shots getting progressively more visible
- Hashtag campaigns building awareness

It IS:

- Bear sharing things he actually believes — ancestral nutrition, family, the outdoors, what keeps him functional after 30 years of hard living
- Each post independently shareable, not dependent on knowing what's coming
- The launch (Post 7) landing as *confirmation* of who Bear already is, not as a product announcement

The test for every post: "Would Bear post this if Modern Savage didn't exist?" If no, rewrite it.

The Narrative Arc

The launch of Modern Savage should feel like the answer to a question Bear has been asking in public for six weeks. Not a commercial announcement — an explanation.

The question: "Why do some people stay functional and others don't — and what is Bear actually doing about it?"

Each week answers a piece of that question, using Bear's real life as the content.

Week-by-Week Plan

WEEK 1 (May 15-21) — "The Body Keeps Score"

Theme: What years of extreme physical output actually does to you — and the honesty Bear rarely shares about it.

Why this week: Most people think of Bear as superhuman. The more interesting truth is that he's been deliberate about recovery and nutrition because he HAS to be — not because he's naturally invincible. This post invites the audience into the real story: that longevity is intentional.

Post format: Long-form caption, single striking image (Bear in a landscape — not filtered, not posed). OR a 60-second video, Bear talking directly to camera, outdoors.

Caption direction:

> *At fifty-something, I think about the machine differently.*
>
> *Not because I've slowed down. But because I understand now what it costs.*
>
> *Thirty years of expeditions, cold water, altitude, sleep deprivation — your body adapts, but it doesn't forget. And what you put in matters more as you age, not less.*
>
> *I've been more deliberate about this over the last few years. Not supplements in the conventional sense. More like: going back to what we've always known works.*
>
> *[2-3 sentences about ancestral nutrition principle — what early explorers and hunters ate, and why it sustained them.]*
>
> *Still figuring it out. But I think I'm closer than I've ever been.*

DO NOT: mention any product. No CTA. No "coming soon." Just Bear being honest.

WEEK 2 (May 22-28) — "What Bear Eats" (Shara and the Boys)

Theme: Family nutrition — not performance, not biohacking. What the Grylls family actually puts in their bodies.

Why this week: The family angle is Modern Savage's unique asset. Shara, Marmaduke, Huckleberry as the first users. No competitor has a family as their authentic origin story. But this post is NOT about the supplement — it's about Bear's values as a father and husband. The supplement becomes context later.

Post format: Photo or short video. Family context — kitchen, dinner table, outdoors together. Real. Not a photoshoot. If the supplement bottle is visible in frame, fine, but not the focus.

Caption direction:

> *Shara has always been better than me at getting this stuff right.*
>
> *Growing up, she was raised on whole foods, real ingredients. I grew up eating whatever kept me alive in the field. We've been meeting in the middle for 25 years.*

> *The non-negotiable in our house is: quality in, quality out. Especially for the boys. They're at the age where you can actually build something — the habits, the foundation.*
>
> *What we've landed on, after a lot of experimentation: as close to whole animal nutrition as you can get in modern life.*
>
> *[Optional: one line about what that looks like in practice — without naming a product. "We supplement specifically, not broadly" or similar.]*

DO NOT: Name the brand. The family photo creates organic reach — keep the caption personal, not commercial.

WEEK 3 (May 29 - Jun 4) — "30 Years in the Field — What Survival Taught Me About Nutrition"

Theme: The ancestral nutrition story, told through Bear's expeditions. This is the intellectual content — the "why organs, not multivitamins" argument, in Bear's lived voice.

Why this week: This is the "education" post that does the heavy lifting for the brand rationale. Bear has unique credibility here — he's actually eaten liver in the field. He's not citing studies. He's citing 30 years of fieldwork. The Liver King tried to do this and got destroyed because he was performing it. Bear lived it.

Post format: Carousel (swipe through) — 5-7 slides. Instagram rewards carousels with extra reach. This content is dense enough to warrant the format.

Slide structure:

1. "What surviving in the wild actually taught me about food" — attention hook, Bear portrait
2. "In the field, you eat the whole animal. The liver first." — Bear in expedition context
3. "There's a reason our ancestors fought over the organs, not the muscle." — one sentence, one stat or observation
4. "Modern nutrition got this exactly backwards — all muscle, no offal." — the contrast
5. "In my 50s, I finally stopped fighting what I know is true." — personal pivot
6. "More on this soon." — the only forward reference, deliberately vague

DO NOT: Put a product in this carousel. The "more on this soon" on slide 6 is the only forward signal, and it's intentionally non-specific.

WEEK 4 (Jun 8-14) — "The Formula" (First Direct Product Mention)

Theme: First time Modern Savage is named — in the context of "this is what I actually take." Not an ad. A confession.

Why now: Three weeks of context means the audience has seen Bear's genuine interest in ancestral nutrition. The product introduction lands as "of course" rather than "oh, he's selling something."

Post format: Bear holding the product. Real setting. Not a packshot. Video preferred (60 seconds, hand-held, authentic). OR: a strong single image with a long-form caption.

Caption direction:

> *I've been taking organ supplements for a while now.*
>
> *Started because I couldn't find anything that matched what I'd seen work in the field — real nutrients from real sources, no filler, no compromise.*
>
> *So I made one.*
>
> *Modern Savage is the blend I've been taking. Liver, heart, kidney — grass-fed, single-source.*
>
> *Not a biohacking product. Not a performance stack. Just: the most nutrient-dense food that exists, in a form you can take every day.*
>
> *Shara takes it. The boys take it.*
>
> *I'll put the link in my bio.*

CTA: Bio link to modernsavage.com waitlist OR the Stripe payment link if the site is live. Calvin to confirm which applies Week 4.

WEEK 5 (Jun 15-21) — Social Proof / Reaction Content

Theme: Real responses from people who've been taking it (if influencer seeding has generated organic content). Or: Bear answering the questions the first wave of audience comments are asking.

Why this week: If influencer seeding started May 19, six weeks of organic use means the micro-influencer community may be posting voluntarily by now. Use this week to amplify genuine third-party content rather than create more brand content.

Option A (if organic content exists): Bear reposts/shares 2-3 pieces of user content — with a caption in his voice: "This is why I made it."

Option B (if organic content is thin): Bear responds to the 3 most common questions from the Week 4 post comments. Video format. Feels conversational, not promotional.

Option C (backup): Bear shares the blood marker / physical metrics angle — "Here's what I've actually noticed." Specific, honest, not overclaiming.

DO NOT: Fabricate testimonials. If the organic content isn't there yet, use Option B or C.

WEEK 6 (Jun 22-28) — "July 1" (Final Build)

Theme: It's coming. The first time an explicit date is mentioned.

Why this week: One week of countdown. At this point the audience who's been following the arc knows the story — they just need the signal to act.

Post format: Video. Bear, 45-60 seconds, talking directly to camera. Simple. He doesn't need a script — the context is built.

Caption direction:

> *July 1.*
>
> *If you've been following along, you know what this is.*
>
> *If you're new here: Modern Savage is the organ supplement I made because I couldn't find one I trusted. Grass-fed beef liver, heart, kidney. The formula I've been taking for months. My family takes it.*
>
> *Launch is July 1. Link in bio if you want to be first.*

CTA: Waitlist or payment link. Calvin to ensure the bio link is active and tested before this post goes live.

Launch Day: July 1

This is Post 2 from the existing bear-post-drafts (`modern-savage-bear-post-drafts-2026-04-24.md`). Calvin already has the copy. It's a strong launch-day post — use it as written.

Additional July 1 actions:

- Email 4 sends from Klaviyo (the launch email to the 170-person waitlist)
- Modern Savage Instagram account posts independently — product focused, less personal than Bear's main account
- Stories on Bear's account: link sticker to the payment page, rotating through the week

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What the Modern Savage Account Posts (Separate from Bear's Main)

The Modern Savage Instagram account has a different job: it's the brand home. Bear's account is the authentic endorsement. These are not the same.

Modern Savage account pillars:

1. **Formula content** — what's in the product, why each ingredient, sourcing

2. **Science translation** — ancestral nutrition research made readable (not Saladino clinical — more accessible)

3. **User content** — real customer posts, reshared with permission

4. **Behind the scenes** — the production story (ACF Pharma, grass-fed sourcing, Ships A Lot)

5. **The Grylls family** — curated family content that fits the brand, with Bear's permission

Modern Savage account does NOT post:

- Lifestyle content unrelated to the product or brand
- Promotional content that contradicts Bear's voice on his main account

- Anything Bear hasn't approved for the brand

Flags for Calvin

Timing: The 6-week arc assumes a mid-May start. If Stripe isn't live by Week 4 (Jun 8-14), push the first product mention to Week 5 and delay the bio link CTA. Don't drive traffic to a page that can't convert.

Running Wild air dates: Weeks 3-6 overlap with Running Wild S9 airing Mondays on Fox Reality. Calvin must coordinate the content calendar so Modern Savage content doesn't compete with Running Wild promotional posts on the same day. The Monday post should always be Running Wild. Modern Savage arc posts go Wed-Thu.

Bear approval: Every post requires Bear's sign-off before scheduling. Calvin submits via Metricool. Bear approves through Jesse (or Olly from May 7 for Week 1 only — Olly reviews tone, Jesse should approve any first product mention). Jesse to review and approve Weeks 1-3 before sailing May 7.

Voice: If any post feels like it was written by a marketing agency, Bear won't approve it. The test is always: does this sound like something Bear would say in a WhatsApp voice note to a friend?

The Liver King Lesson (Don't Forget)

Ancestral Supplements was built on a man performing a lifestyle he wasn't living. When that was exposed, the brand collapsed.

Modern Savage's entire competitive advantage is that Bear genuinely does this. He was in the Daily Mail talking about organ supplements in 2023 — before Modern Savage existed. That is the moat.

Every piece of content in this arc must protect that authenticity. If there is any post that Bear would not have approved before Modern Savage launched — that post is a liability, not an asset. Cut it.

The moment this arc feels like a product launch campaign rather than Bear sharing his life, the Liver King problem starts.